



JOUR 4251

Advertising and behavior change (Principles of compliance) - Ch 7 part 1



Principles of compliance

Compliance

= doing the behavior; giving in; doing it because it has been requested

You see social influence everywhere:

Infomercials, social media, direct mail, traditional advertisement

In Chapter 7, we are thinking about situations where the attitude doesn't matter. It's the behavior that does.

Social influence



We are talking about social influence without pressure

Tactics used to foster compliance are:

- **Closeness:** in space and time
- **Specificity:** buy a particular product, donate to a specific charity

Refer to immediate action or choice environment

Do NOT result in long-term behavior choices - affects singular behavior

Automaticity is often cited as the reason compliance occurs.

You don't think. You just agree.

Social influence relies on techniques that are **subtle** and **outside of conscious awareness**.



Scripts

Knowledge structures about sequence of events.

Examples

Restaurant: Fancy restaurant vs. fast food restaurant

Bus: checking in when entering vs. exiting

We do not pay attention - we are mindless during scripts



Copier experiment

“Excuse me, I have five pages. May I use the Xerox Machine?”

“Excuse me, I have five pages. May I use the Xerox Machine because I am in a rush?”

“Excuse me, I have five pages. May I use the Xerox machine because I have to make copies?”

Least effort principle

You only pay attention if it is worth your while to (motivated).

This doesn't work for big favors.

Then, real excuse is mildly effective. Fake one not.



Heuristics

Another knowledge structure that helps simplify complex decisions

Sufficiency principle

Tendency to strike a balance between minimizing cognitive effort and satisfying motivational concerns

(when not motivated; you don't put effort in)

Who is going to win the tournament?





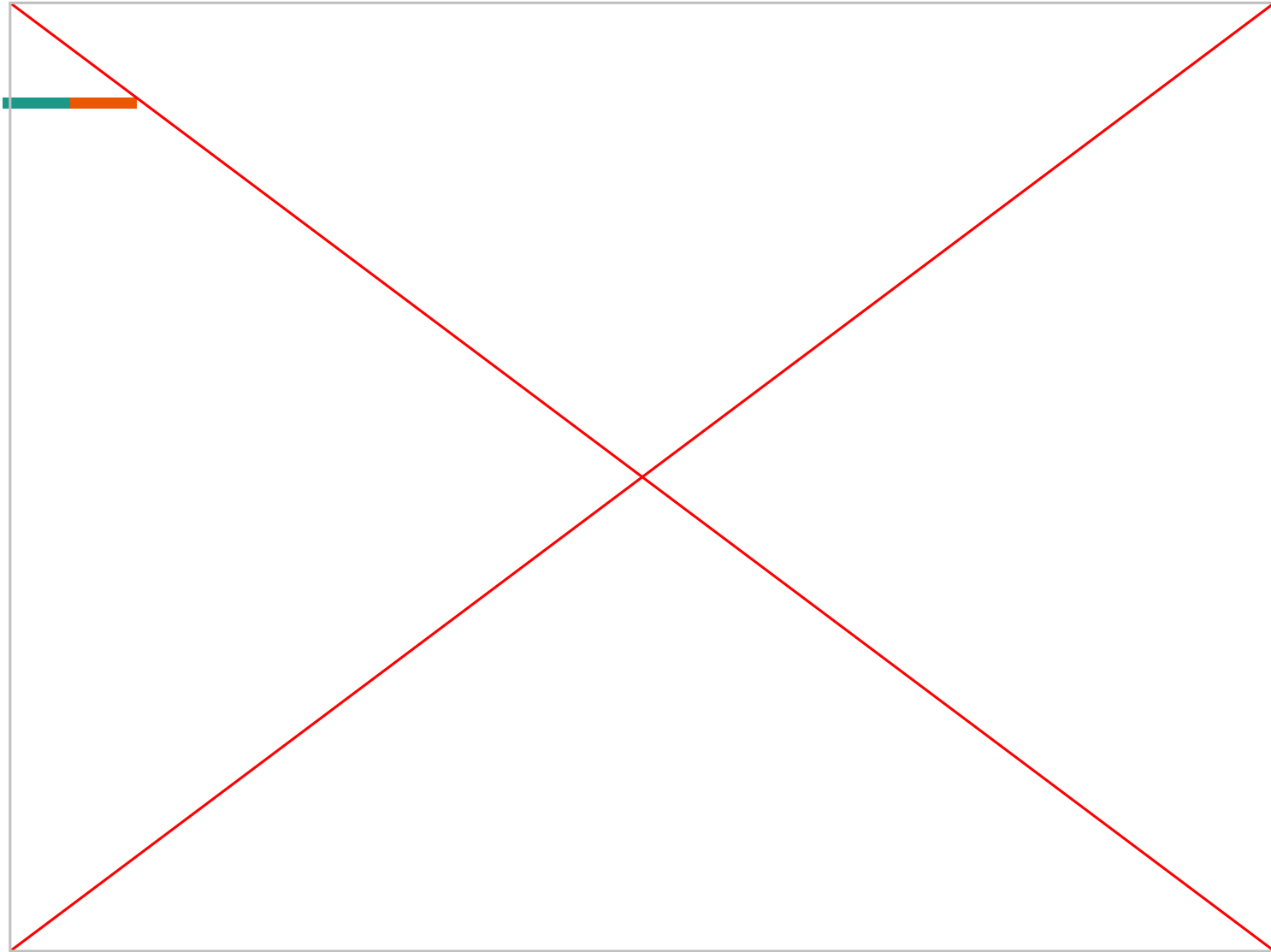
Recognition Heuristic

Function of just recognizing the stimulus

We want to be efficient. This is an efficient way of not thinking.

How can you apply this to advertising?

Principles of compliance





What's next?

- Continue reading Chapter 7
- Assignment #4 on behavior is due by **April 23**